Determinants of Students' Motivation towards Entrepreneurship: The Case of the College of Business, Systems Plus College Foundation, Angeles City

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Abstract

This research work analyzes the determinants of students' motivation towards entrepreneurship at the College of Business, Systems Plus College Foundation, Angeles City. Specifically, the research wants to know and examine the significant determinants that affect the motivation towards entrepreneurship from among the students of the College of Business. The influence of role models, image of entrepreneurship, curriculum and content, promotion of entrepreneurial education, entrepreneurial programs, the personal learning approach and the over-all attitude of the respondents towards students' motivation of entrepreneurship is the main focus of the study. The study used descriptive design using a survey questionnaire to describe the profile and entrepreneurial inclinations of the respondents. Simple random sampling was utilized to derive the desired target respondents. The sampling had targeted the students at the College of Business.The sample frame was computed with 95 % confidence level and confidence interval of 2, hence the sample size needed was 380. There were 380 questionnaires distributed and were returned. Upon validation, only 376 were considered as some vital items were not filled up or left unanswered. Analysis of data was done through SPSS (Statistical Package for Social Sciences) to calculate and determine descriptive statistics and correlation analysis. The inter item correlation was generated to determine statistical results as to the relationship on the determinants of motivation towards entrepreneurship. The findings showed that the determinants identified and analyzed presented a positive correlation result. Conclusively, the determinants affirms that entrepreneurship education established an affirmative answer that would facilitate future research direction and policies to strengthen entrepreneurship on higher education institutions.

Keywords: entrepreneurship education; entrepreneurial inclination; curriculum and content; internship programs; learning approach; college students, entrepreneurship

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Introduction

The idea of entrepreneurship or establishment of small businesses is always an option after graduation or any individual who is already tired or fed up working in an organization. In all sectors nowadays, in the Philippines, people are talking and exploring the idea of entrepreneurship; the government had spearheaded many programs to spur the interest in the field, policy makers, private organizations, chamber of commerce, women's sector, academics, and college students also had shown interest in it. In the Philippines, self – employment becomes an option as unemployment still a problem since it is more attractive and rewarding career option for the people particularly for university or college students and graduates. Goel, Vohra, Zhang, and Arora (2007) had viewed that entrepreneurship is about building and overseeing a business for profit and growth. The idea is supported McMullan, Long and Graham (in Lena & Wong, 2004) that entrepreneurship is a catalyst for emerging and creating new lines of commercial initiatives.

It was acknowledged by Badulescu, and Dodescu (2010), that people's desire of self-achievement, the demand for more money and higher social and professional status triggers them to commence a commercial enterprise, especially the adult females. Goodbody Economic Consultants (2002) noted that entrepreneurs are achievement driven, faced challenges, persevere, work hard and strong willed, flexible, eager and willing to learn to better their job. Established along with the written report by Allen (2006), he stated that entrepreneurs are critical decision makers and problem solvers, they don't depend on others.

The importance of entrepreneurial undertaking is crucial for the economic system to turn. Entrepreneurship means a line of work that would create job opportunities and economic actions. It indicates that proving a business is an alternative choice for alumni and the youth sector. Approximately 25% of the population are categorized under the youth sector, of which 39% are employed, but still 40% are within the economic threshold level of poverty line. In this regards, the option to encourage the youth towards entrepreneurship is important as it is now embracing globally. Youth entrepreneurship will benefit both the youth sector and the economic system.

This research targeted at naming the factors or determinants of entrepreneurial inclinations of students. In the end, the result will provide the researcher a better reason to foster the entrepreneurial life and attitude of scholarly people in taking on an entrepreneurial enterprise.

Objectives of the Study

This study aimed to assess the students' entrepreneurial motivations at the College of Business, Systems Plus College Foundation, Angeles City. This research described the profile of the respondents; examined entrepreneurial motivations of the respondents; knowing the determinants that motivated the students for entrepreneurial undertaking and willingness to take an entrepreneurial endeavor; and assessing the role of the College in promoting entrepreneurship.

The findings of the study provided ideas to persuade students towards entrepreneurship. In closing, entrepreneurship was pushed as an option for College of Business, Systems Plus College Foundation students after graduation.

Literature Review

Entrepreneurship education is a key strategy in academic institution to foster entrepreneurial interest to students (Linan 2004). The essential requisite behind this program is that entrepreneurship is both taught and learnt.

Resurrection (2011) stated that many governments have not been remiss in initiating programs and actions to promote entrepreneurial efforts, especially among the young to encourage them to be an active subscriber to the thrust of poverty alleviation. Despite of these efforts mindsets of students still appear to be centered on corporate engagement.

Pihie (2009) showed that the students had received a moderate score on all constructs related to entrepreneurial intention and entrepreneurial self-efficacy in the aspects of management, financial and marketing. Furthermore, positive entrepreneurial aspiration showed a positive relationship on entrepreneurship intention and self-efficacy compared to negative aspiration from among the students. One of the significant findings had shown that perceived entrepreneurship learnt at university impacts attitudes towards entrepreneurial career and perceived behavioral control. According to Saravanakumar, et. al. (2012), the students with lower indices on all of the measures have low entrepreneurial inclinations. Therefore, it was

suggested to educational institutions to continuously enhance or promote entrepreneurship. The findings indicate the challenge facing management education if they are to create entrepreneurs as, increasingly, appears to be required.

Similar to this line of research, Wang, et. al. (2011) proposes that there is an entrepreneurial intention among international students, and that a large portion of these students have rather strong entrepreneurial intention. This field may bring more awareness for educators so they can help raise the valuable spirit among this special group and thus possibly bring out more entrepreneurs. In summation, this study has demonstrated that perceived feasibility is a stronger predictor of entrepreneurial intention than personal desirability; therefore, university educators may want to enhance perceived feasibility if they intend to increase the level of entrepreneurial intention. Grassl et al. (2005), acknowledged that among business students, personality factors and perceived feasibility determine entrepreneurial inclination. Kuehn (2008) noted influencing students to take entrepreneurial activities takes practical ways from the educational institutions. The findings was collaborated by Akram et. Al (2010) that encouraging more students to become entrepreneurs by providing more awareness on the benefits of becoming entrepreneurs and in turn, contributing to the growth of the countries' economies and global competitiveness

Researches over the years had revealed the contribution of entrepreneurship education towards students' entrepreneurial inclination. Mueller and Volery (2006), ascertained the importance of entrepreneurship education in influencing the students' decision on entrepreneurship as a career option. The prior exposure to entrepreneurship education, develop a person's level of self efficacy (Wilson, 2007). Entrepreneurship education has shown more student's inclinations towards starting their own business (Noel, 1998), because entrepreneurship education develops the interest of students to start their own business with innovation (Wilson, 2007). Nurmi and Paasiao (2007) stated that universities and other institutions of higher learning were tasked to play a key role in imbibing the entrepreneurial knowledge and skills to students that will be spark career endeavors.

It is worthwhile to note that the appropriateness of curriculum and teaching methods in developing students entrepreneurial competencies and skills is a major challenge to academic institutions (Garavan and O'Cinneide 1994). Brown (1999) argues that the entrepreneurship course content should emphasize more on hands-on teaching methods. In response, Vesper

(2004) identified various knowledge useful for entrepreneurs and hence the entrepreneurship course content should be built up according to his knowledge: business-general knowledge, venture-general knowledge, opportunity-specific knowledge, venture-specific knowledge. It was identified by numerous researchers that there are lots of approaches to teach entrepreneurship ranging from using textbooks (Fiet, 2002), examinations (McMullan and Cahoon, 1979), business plan (Audet, 2000), life histories of working entrepreneurs (McKenzie 2004); guest lecturers (Brown 1999; Klandt and Volkmann 2006) and visiting business organizations (Cooper, Bottomley, et al. 2004).

Mahlberg (1996) described the significant role of academic institutions in shaping entrepreneurial cultures and aspirations of students while they are studying to survive in a turbulent business environment (Autio, Keeley, et al, 1997; Landstrom, 2005). It is recognized that universities are seedbeds of entrepreneurship (Bygrave, 2004). Universities, in this regard, should position themselves as a hub of entrepreneurship by making solid contributions in fostering an entrepreneurial environment that combines components that lead to the development of entrepreneurship (Gnyawali and Fogel, 1994).

The career path of entrepreneurship creates opportunities for students to achieve financial independence and benefit the economy by contributing to job creation, innovation, and economic development. Entrepreneurs have shown a higher degree of financial independence, creative freedoms, more eminent sense of pride, and personal indulgence.

Research Framework

The study was aimed to examine the determinants of students' motivation towards entrepreneurship at the College of Business, Systems Plus College Foundation, which include the following factors: attitude, image of entrepreneurship, role models, promotion of entrepreneurship at the college, curriculum and content, entrepreneurial program, and personal learning.

Research Design

The study used descriptive design using a survey questionnaire to describe the profile and entrepreneurial inclinations of students at the College of Business, Systems Plus College Foundation. This study aimed to provide a description of the relationship among the following variables: demographic profile and entrepreneurial intentions of students. This research design

was chosen because it can provide essential knowledge about the subject under study as well as its relationship with each other.

Simple random sampling was utilized to derive the desired target respondents. The sampling had targeted the students at the College of Business, Systems Plus College Foundation. A structured questionnaire was administered to the identified respondents. Analysis of data was done through SPSS (Statistical Package for Social Sciences) to calculate and determine descriptive statistics and correlation analysis. Descriptive statistical analysis was generated and data were tabulated using percentages for the non-numeric information gathered where the findings were summarized, explained and interpreted.

Participants

The respondents are students at College of Business, Systems Plus College Foundation for AY 2015-2016. The sample frame was computed with 99% confidence level and confidence interval of 8, hence the sample size needed was 380. There were 380 questionnaires distributed and were returned. Upon validation, only 376 were considered as some vital items were not filled up or left unanswered.

Instrument

The study used the questionnaire developed by Linan and Chen (2009), known as the Entrepreneurial Intention Questionnaire (EIQ) which was modified. The questionnaire consisted of the profile and factors that determine the entrepreneurial motivations of the respondents. Questionnaires were pre tested and validated its reliability using Cronbach's Alpha reliability scale. In order to obtain necessary data, the researcher used a survey questionnaire and was administered to the students during the lecture hour.

Data Analysis

The data gathered were tallied and interpreted using different statistical tools such as frequency and percentage; weighted mean and Pearson Square test. The mentioned tools were used based on the objectives of the study. The scales used in the questionnaire were based on a 5-point Likert scale for each close-ended question. Prior to conducting the main study, a pilot test was conducted to improve the reliability and validity of the questionnaire. The participation in this study was on a voluntary basis and the administration was supervised and monitored by the lecturers; immediately, the questionnaires were retrieved. SPSS version 18.0 was used to analyze the data.

Research Timeline:

	Activities	Date	Remarks
1	Writing of Research Proposal (topic, planning of activities)	June 2015	Meet Research Unit
2	Approval/ Evaluation of Resources Needed	July 2015	Planned for printing of questionnaires, identified respondents
3	Writing of Introduction, Review of Literature	August 2015	Gather materials
4	Research Methodology	September 2015	Pre-test questionnaire
5	Data Gathering	September-December, 2015	Questionnaire administered through students
6	Data Analysis and Interpretations	January-February, 2016	Statistical treatment of data
7	Findings, Recommendations, Conclusion	March 2016	Brainstorming
8	Final Draft	March 2016	Encoding of draft paper
9	Presentation	April 2016	Colloquium